CalWORKs Program Guide: B. Behavioral Health Services

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 10-011: SUPPORTIVE SERVICES
TITLE: B. BEHAVIORAL HEALTH SERVICES

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE

The County of San Diego Health and Human Services Agency (HHSA) provides behavioral health services to Welfare-to-Work (WTW) participants to identify, address, and remove mental health and substance abuse barriers that impede self-sufficiency and sustained employment. This section outlines caseworker screening, referral protocols, clinical assessment sequencing, and participation credit rules under California Department of Social Services (CDSS) Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) EAS 42-711.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & CLINICAL REFERRALS

? Screening & Identification: Caseworkers must screen WTW participants for behavioral health concerns during orientation, appraisal, and at any subsequent WTW interaction or reassessment. Screening tools evaluate emotional, psychological, or substance-related barriers.

? Voluntary Treatment & Confidentiality: Behavioral health services are strictly voluntary and confidential. Participation in clinical counseling or substance treatment cannot be mandated as a condition of cash aid eligibility.

? Core Hours & Concurrent Activities: Clinical assessment, psychotherapy, psychiatric treatment, and residential or outpatient substance abuse rehabilitation count toward mandatory WTW hourly participation requirements (20, 30, or 35 hours per week) as approved activities.

? Dedicated Service Providers: Services are coordinated directly with County Behavioral Health Services (BHS), contracted clinical clinics, and licensed community mental health centers.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

? Referral Generation: When a customer expresses interest or displays need, generate an immediate referral via the automated system and issue the Behavioral Health Information Notice.

? Transportation & Child Care: Authorize immediate supportive services, including public transit passes or mileage reimbursement and Stage One Child Care payments, to ensure the participant can attend clinical appointments without hardship.

? Case Narrative & Medical Safeguards: Document the referral in the case narrative without disclosing confidential medical diagnoses or psychotropic medication details. Comply with strict HIPAA and state confidentiality protections.